INSIDE STUDIO SP · VST3 · AU

STOMPBOX

GUITAR PEDALBOARD

Step-by-step manual

Version 0.2.0 · Windows and macOS · VST3 and AU



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What is STOMPBOX

STOMPBOX is a complete **guitar pedalboard** inside your DAW. You record the guitar clean (straight into the interface, no amp) and build the tone in the plugin:

- **Up to 10 pedals in series**, in any order you like: compressor, overdrives, distortion, fuzz, wah, phaser, chorus, delay, reverb and pitch shifter.
- **AMP + CAB** at the end: 5 amps and a cabinet with a mic.
- **NOISE GATE** and **tuner** at the input.
- **24 factory presets** plus your own presets.

The signal path is always: `INPUT → NOISE GATE → pedals 1 to 10 → AMP → CAB → OUTPUT`.

Before you start

ITEM	DETAILS
Format	VST3 (Windows and macOS) and AU (macOS). Windows 10 or 11, 64-bit; macOS 11 Big Sur or newer.
Where to insert	On the clean-recorded (DI) guitar track, as an insert effect.
DAWs	Any DAW that loads VST3 or AU: Ableton Live, FL Studio, Logic, Cubase, Bitwig, Reaper, Studio One…

Installation and activation

1. Download the installer from the link in your purchase e-mail and choose Windows or Mac.
2. Run the installer and open your DAW. If needed, have it scan for new plugins (rescan).
3. The first time you open STOMPBOX, enter the **e-mail** and the **license token** you received.

> **LICENSE.** The same token works on up to 2 computers. To switch machines, deactivate it on the old computer and the slot is freed. Internet is only needed to activate: after that it works up to 45 days offline and renews by itself. To see the license: `≡ MENU` › `Licença…` (license)

> **NOT ACTIVATED**, the plugin opens but passes the sound straight through, unprocessed.

STEP 1

1 Insert it on the guitar track

1. Record (or play live) the guitar plugged **straight into the interface**, no amp.
2. Insert STOMPBOX on its track.
3. Play and set the `INPUT` (−24 to +24 dB, default 0 dB) watching the **IN** meter beside it: the signal should move well without sitting at the top.



INPUT, AFINADOR (tuner), IN meter and NOISE GATE

STEP 2

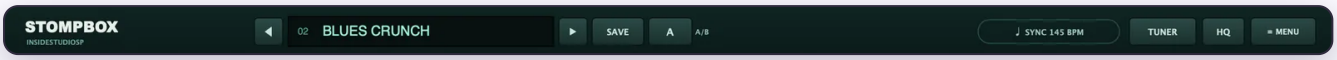
2 Tune up and set the NOISE GATE

- The input **AFINADOR** (tuner) is always on and doesn't cut the sound ("toque uma corda": play a string).
- Click it or the `TUNER` button at the top to open the big tuner. With the TUNER open the **output is muted**, so you can tune in silence. Click again to close it.
- NOISE GATE `THRESHOLD` (−90 to −20 dB; fully down it's off): raise it until the hiss disappears when you stop playing. `RELEASE` (10 to 500 ms, default 120 ms): how long the gate takes to close.
- The light below shows **ABERTO** (open), **FECHADO** (closed) or **GATE OFF**.

> **TIP.** With lots of gain (IRON HG, fuzz) the hiss shows up more: raise the THRESHOLD until the silence between phrases is clean, without cutting the note tails.

STEP 3

3 Pick a preset



- Click the **preset name** to open the list; the ◀ ▶ arrows step to the previous and next one.
- The list holds the factory presets, the **Meus presets** (my presets) submenu and **Salvar como novo...** (save as new).
- `SAVE` saves your sound as a preset. `≡ MENU` › **Abrir a pasta de presets** (open presets folder) shows where they live.

Factory presets

01 INIT	02 BLUES CRUNCH	03 JHON MORELO	04 SDASH
05 JHON FRUSHANTE	06 DAVID GILMOR	07 JIMMY HENDRIQUES	08 LINKIN PARQUE
09 TONY IOMI	10 ZAKK WAILD	11 KURT COBAINHO	12 THE EJ
13 STEVIE RAY VAUGHAM	14 EDDIE VAN HALLEN	15 JACK WHITTE	16 KIRK HAMETT
17 MARK KNOPFLA	18 BILLY CORGANN	19 BRIAN MAIO	20 ANGUS YOUNGUE
21 CARLOS SANTANNA	22 JONNY GREENWOODY	23 AMBIENT SWELL	24 CHIME JANGLE

The presets are inspired by the tones of famous guitarists. Some have pedals **on the board but switched off**: just "stomp" the footswitch to use them.

STEP 4

4 Compare with A / B

The `A` / `B` button at the top stores **two sounds** and switches between them. **Right-click** it to **Copiar A → B** (copy A → B, or B → A) and start a variation from the current sound.

STEP 5

5 Build the board



The signal runs in series, left to right, into the AMP / CAB.

- **Add:** click the `+` on the first free slot and pick the pedal in the selector (sorted by type).
- **Reorder:** drag the pedal to another slot.
- **On / off:** click the **footswitch** (the red LED lights up). Switching is smooth, no clicks; a pedal that's off shows `BYPASS` and uses no CPU.
- **Remove:** the `×` above the pedal.
- **Right-click the pedal:** Trocar pedal... (swap pedal), Duplicar (duplicate), Knobs no padrão (knobs to default), Mover para a esquerda/direita (move left/right), Remover (remove).
- With more pedals than fit on screen, use the side arrows or the bar below the board.

Turning the knobs

- **Drag** up and down; hold **Shift** for fine adjustment. The **mouse wheel** works too.
- **Double-click** resets the knob to default. While you turn it, the value shows up (ms, Hz, interval...).
- **Switches** (e.g. CLASSIC/MODERN) change with one click.

> **AUTOMATION.** Each board slot shows up as parameters in the DAW (*Slot N Pedal / On / Knob 1..4 / Switch*): you can automate, for example, turning the delay on only for the solo.

The 11 pedals

PEDAL	WHAT IT IS	KNOBS	SWITCH
SQUASH	Compressor	LEVEL, SUSTAIN, ATTACK, BLEND	—
HUMP	Overdrive with a mid hump	DRIVE, LEVEL, TONE	—
CLEARCUT	Transparent overdrive (clean + clipped)	GAIN, TREBLE, VOLUME, BASS	HEADROOM LOW / HIGH
GRIT	Distortion	DIST, FILTER, VOLUME	CLASSIC / MODERN
WOOLLY	Two-transistor fuzz	VOLUME, FUZZ	GE / SI
QUACK	Wah	PEDAL, Q, RANGE	PEDAL / AUTO
SWIRL	4-stage phaser	SPEED (0.08 to 9 Hz), FEEDBACK	VINTAGE / MODERN
TIDE	Chorus / vibrato (stereo)	RATE (0.1 to 8 Hz), DEPTH, MIX	CHORUS / VIBRATO
ECHO	Analog or tape delay (stereo)	TIME (40 to 1200 ms), FEEDBACK, MIX, MOD	BBD / TAPE
HALO	Reverb (stereo)	DECAY, TONE, MIX, PRE-DLY	SPRING / PLATE / HALL
BENDER	Pitch-shifter pedal	PEDAL, SHIFT, MIX	WHAMMY / DETUNE

Expression pedals: QUACK and BENDER

Drag their **pedal** up and down (heel ↔ toe). On QUACK, the `AUTO` switch makes the wah move by itself. On BENDER, heel is the normal sound and toe is the interval chosen in `SHIFT`: **−2 OCT, −1 OCT, −5TH, +4TH, +5TH, +1 OCT, +2 OCT**. In `DETUNE`, it detunes slightly (doubling effect). MIX at 10 = shifted sound only.

Tempo SYNC

Turn on the `♩ SYNC … BPM` chip at the top and the time follows the DAW's BPM:

- **ECHO** (TIME): 1/32 to dotted 1/2 (includes triplets and dotted values).
- **SWIRL** and **TIDE** (SPEED / RATE): 2 BAR, 1 BAR, 1/2, 1/4, 1/8, 1/8T, 1/16.

STEP 6

6 AMP + CAB



Amplifier

AMP	CHARACTER
BLONDE 65	American clean.
CHIME 30	Class A, top boost.
PLEX 68	British crunch.
CITRUS	Thick British.
IRON HG	Modern high gain.

`GAIN`, `BASS`, `MID`, `TREBLE`, `PRESENCE` and `MASTER` knobs (0 to 10, default 5) and the `CLEAN / DIRTY` switch (the amp's 2 channels).

Cabinet and microphone (CAB)

CONTROL	WHAT IT DOES
1x12 OPEN / 2x12 / 4x12	Cabinet size (default 4x12).
DYN / RIBBON	Mic type: dynamic or ribbon.
MIC POS	Mic position: from the speaker center (0) to the edge (10).
DISTANCE	Mic distance: close to far.

> **USING A REAL AMP?** Turn off `AMP + CAB ON` and STOMPBOX becomes just the pedalboard, with a direct output to an amplifier or another amp sim.

STEP 7

7 Output level

Set the `OUTPUT` (−24 to +12 dB, default 0 dB) watching the **OUT** meter. Use it to match volume between presets or to compare against the bypassed sound at the same level.

STEP 8

8 HQ, MENU and window

BUTTON	WHAT IT DOES
HQ	16× oversampling (default: off). Better saturation quality, at a higher CPU cost.
≡ MENU	**Tamanho da janela** (window size, from 960 × 540 to 1920 × 1080), **Abrir a pasta de presets**, **Licença…** and **Sobre o STOMPBOX** (about).
TUNER	Opens the big tuner (output muted).
♩ SYNC	Locks the pedal times to the DAW's BPM.

FAQ and troubleshooting

SITUATION	WHAT TO DO
The sound doesn't change at all	Check the license (≡ MENU › Licença…). Not activated, the sound passes straight through. Also make sure the TUNER isn't open (it mutes the output).
No sound	The big TUNER is open or the NOISE GATE is set too high: close the TUNER and lower the THRESHOLD.
Hiss between phrases	Raise the NOISE GATE THRESHOLD.
Note tails get cut off	Lower the THRESHOLD or raise the gate RELEASE.
Muddy / overly distorted sound	Lower the INPUT, the amp GAIN or the pedals' drive. Try the amp's CLEAN switch.
Delay out of time with the song	Turn on SYNC at the top.
High CPU	Turn off HQ. Pedals that are off use no CPU.

30-second summary

1. Clean guitar (DI) → STOMPBOX on its track.
2. Set the **INPUT**, tune up (**TUNER**) and set the **NOISE GATE**.
3. Pick a **preset** or build the board with **+**.
4. Drag to reorder; the footswitch turns pedals on and off.
5. Choose the **AMP**, the CLEAN/DIRTY channel and the **CAB** with its mic.
6. Compare with **A / B** and match the volume with **OUTPUT**.
7. **SAVE** to keep your sound.

SUPPORT. Questions, suggestions or issues: **contato@insidestudiosp.com.br** · **insidestudiosp.com.br**